the first six of these nine years, Pakistan was still a British dominion. So, it can be argued that despite Pakistan being a member of SEATO and CENTO, and despite being a part of the then British Empire, it had already begun to pursue a clandestine military and strategic alliance with China.

In 1954, Mao had discarded the ideological differences inherent in politically flirting with Pakistan. Often enough, Beijing expressed its views that it would not object to Pakistan joining CENTO and SEATO as long as the country stays away from any activity directed at China. At the Bandung Conference in April 1955, Pakistan Premier Mohammad Ali Bogra met Chinese Premier Chou En-lai.[10] It was in Bandung that these two leaders agreed that China and India were emerging as rivals fighting for leadership amongst Afro-Asian countries. They decided that China and Pakistan should cooperate to increase their leverage against Moscow and New Delhi and that the two countries could evolve a working relationship despite their ideological differences.

There is circumstantial evidence to suggest that as a consequence of these Chinese political overtures to the Pakistani leadership in the 1950s, there was a succession of meetings held between Cawthorn and the chief of China's Central Investigation Department, Kang Sheng. These meetings crystallised into a combined Sino-Pak approach to dealing with India and became a bedrock of the ISI's institutionalised strategic and tactical range of options against India. The creation of this Sino-Pak strategic and military calculus was the main reason for the extraordinarily long tenure of Cawthorn as the ISI Chief. The Bible of tradecraft that he conceived, probably still determines the actions of the ISI's dealings with India.

Pakistan's Second Bout of Adventurism

The years after Cawthorn's retirement were dominated by the strengthening of Sino-Pak relations and the Sino-Indian War of 1962. By 1965, the time was ripe to put into practice the elements of Cawthorn' s plan. In the same year, the Pakistani Army began continuous shelling of the Srinagar-Leh highway from vantage positions above Kargil.[11] After a tough battle, the